

EVIDENCE FILE – Phase 1 Customer & Problem Validation

Project: JobShield AI – trust check for job postings (fake-job and scam screening for final-year students, Tamil Nadu) | Team ID: [enter] | Vertical: [enter]

0. Read this first

This file supports the Phase 1 submission claim by claim. It separates two kinds of evidence, because they cannot be treated alike:

- **Secondary sources (S1–S5):** published sources cited in the Phase 1 submission. They give national and contextual evidence on exposure to suspicious jobs, confidence, money loss, missed genuine jobs, trust and cyber risk. Every figure below is a **reported** survey figure, not something the team measured.
- **Primary evidence (E01–E07):** interviews, walkthroughs and the TPO record review. These must come from the team. This file records what each one is for and what it must contain; it does not contain invented quotes, counts or dates. Where a finding is not yet written up, the cell says **[enter]**.

Status key used in the tables: V = verified published source (reported figure); P = primary evidence the team must collect or confirm; T = team proposal or target (not evidence); R = revise or remove unless you can back it.

1. Evidence register (fill as you collect)

One row per piece of proof saved in your view-only evidence folder. Keep the IDs, change the contents.

ID	Type	What the file must contain	Purpose / relevance
E01–E05	Anonymized final-year student interviews and walkthroughs of one real recent job posting.	Per interview: notes, date, role (final-year student), college code (anonymized), consent noted, one quote. Walkthrough: each check made, time taken, confidence in the verdict.	Primary-user evidence of the current workflow, checks made, time taken and confidence when judging postings.
E06	College Training and Placement Officer (TPO) interview / record review.	Notes, date, consent, views on value, permission to pilot, budget, hosting and compliance conditions.	Tests value, permission, adoption conditions, budget, hosting and compliance considerations.
E07	Other affected stakeholder: a senior previously scammed, or a genuine recruiter.	Same as above; include any disagreement with the team's first belief.	Challenges one-sided assumptions and adds an employer / affected-stakeholder perspective.
S1–S5	Secondary sources cited in the Phase 1 submission.	Full citation and working link for each; the figure it supports (see Section 3).	National and contextual evidence on exposure, confidence, money loss, missed genuine jobs, trust and cyber risk.
Evidence Log	Log connecting claims and assumptions to evidence IDs and next tests.	One row per claim: status, evidence ID, next test (see Section 4.3).	Tracks what is known, what is still assumed and what needs validation.
Permitted screenshots	Screenshots of the workflow or evidence, where public sharing is permitted.	Cropped or blurred images only; permission noted for each.	Visual support while protecting personal and confidential information.

2. Claim-by-claim evidence map

Users and current workflow

Claim	Status	Supporting evidence / what to do
Primary users are final-year job-seeking students in Tamil Nadu colleges.	P	E01–E05. Enter the real colleges (as codes) and number of students interviewed.

Claim	Status	Supporting evidence / what to do
A posting is shared in a WhatsApp group or spotted on a job board. The student checks the company name and decides whether to apply; they may Google the company, ask seniors and inspect the sender or contact details.	P	E01-E05 walkthroughs of one real recent posting. Add the actual steps, time taken and one genuine quote; delete anything the students did not say.
Current alternatives are manual checks on LinkedIn / company sites and asking seniors. They catch obvious scams and cost nothing, but do not scale.	P	E01-E05. Confirm with students what these checks missed on the real posting.

Pain, exposure and consequences

Claim	Status	Supporting evidence / what to do
Students lose time on fake listings; some report losing money or data. Manual checks do not scale to dozens of daily listings.	P	E01-E05 for time lost and the real case; “dozens of daily listings” needs a student’s count (enter it) or should be marked as reported.
93% of Indian job seekers were reported as having met suspicious or fraudulent openings.	V	S1. Reported national survey figure; not college-specific.
51% of Indian job seekers were reported as not confident telling a genuine recruiter from a scammer (strongest quantitative signal).	V	S1. Reported national figure; confirm the student confidence level in E01-E05.
14% reportedly missed genuine jobs and 31% became less trusting of recruiters.	V	S2. Reported figures; wording must stay “reportedly”.
Money-loss estimates vary: 3% in S4 versus 46% for Gen Z in S1.	V	S4 and S1. The two measure different groups; show both and do not average or pick one without saying why.

Adoption and remaining uncertainty

Claim	Status	Supporting evidence / what to do
The TPO could pilot the approach through the placement cell.	P	E06. Permission and adoption conditions are not yet tested: quote only what the TPO actually said.
A trust signal changes application decisions, not just awareness.	R	Unproven. Test with students (E01-E05 follow-up) before claiming it.
College-specific exposure and willingness to act on a trust signal.	R	Unproven. The national figures (S1, S2, S4) are not college data; collect at least one college-level signal.
Target for early success (for example fewer applications to fake postings).	T	Team proposal only. Set the baseline from E01-E05 first and label the target as a target.

3. Secondary sources

ID	Source	Link	What it supports	Limits / caution
S1	[Enter full citation: author, title, year]	[Enter working link]	93% of Indian job seekers reported meeting suspicious or fraudulent openings; 51% not confident telling a genuine recruiter from a scammer; 46% money loss among Gen Z.	Survey-reported, national. The 46% is a Gen Z subgroup and conflicts with S4’s 3%.
S2	[Enter full citation]	[Enter working link]	14% reportedly missed genuine jobs; 31% became less trusting of recruiters.	Reported, national; not college-specific.

ID	Source	Link	What it supports	Limits / caution
S3	[Enter full citation]	[Enter working link]	[Enter the figure or context it supports; the summary attributes no specific figure to S3.]	Attribute only what this source actually says.
S4	[Enter full citation]	[Enter working link]	Money-loss estimate of 3%.	Lower than S1's 46%; different population and definition likely.
S5	[Enter full citation]	[Enter working link]	[Enter the figure or context it supports; the summary attributes no specific figure to S5.] Register lists cyber risk as one theme across S1–S5.	Attribute only what this source actually says.

Gap: the evidence so far does not show whether a trust signal changes what students do, how much time one check takes, or how exposed students at a specific college are. E01–E07 must fill these gaps; if they cannot, say so in the submission and describe the consequence as reported rather than measured.

4. Tools to collect the primary evidence

4.1 Interview guide (20–30 min, students and TPO)

- Walk me through the last job posting you doubted. What happened, step by step?
- What do you check today, in what order, and how long does it take?
- Who do you ask (seniors, friends, WhatsApp groups) and what sites do you use (Google, LinkedIn, company site)?
- Has a fake posting cost you time, money or personal data? What exactly?
- Have you skipped a genuine posting because you were unsure? What happened?
- What works well about today's checks? What would you not want to lose?
- Would a trust signal on a posting change whether you apply? What would make you trust or ignore it?
- TPO / recruiter: who must approve a pilot, and what are the concerns about budget, hosting and data?
- Ask for disagreement: what would most people in your group say differently?

4.2 Walkthrough checklist (one real recent posting)

- Date, college code (anonymized), role observed, consent reference
- Where the posting came from (WhatsApp group, job board, other) and start / end time
- Each check made (company name, Google, seniors, sender or contact details) with its duration
- Any doubt raised, who was asked, and the final apply / skip decision with confidence level
- Outcome and any later correction. Record no names, phone numbers or personal data unless explicitly permitted.

4.3 Evidence log

Claim / assumption	Evidence ID	Status	Next test
Students check postings manually and cannot keep up with daily volume	E01–E05	P	Record time and number of postings per student
Most job seekers meet suspicious openings (93%)	S1	V	Ask students for their own recent count
Many job seekers are not confident spotting scams (51%)	S1	V	Record each student's confidence on the real posting
Fake postings cause missed genuine jobs and lost trust (14%, 31%)	S2	V	Ask students whether they skipped a genuine job
Money-loss rate is uncertain (3% vs 46% Gen Z)	S4, S1	V	Ask E07 senior and students about actual losses

Claim / assumption	Evidence ID	Status	Next test
TPO would pilot through the placement cell	E06	P	Record the TPO's conditions, permission and budget view
A trust signal changes application decisions	–	R	Show a sample signal and record whether the decision changes

4.4 Consent, anonymization and screenshots

- Tell each person who you are, the purpose, what you will record, and that they can stop or withdraw.
- Record consent (signed note, email or recorded verbal consent) and save it in the evidence folder.
- Use codes such as StudentA, CollegeA, TPO1. Store no real names, phone numbers or profile links.
- Screenshots: crop or blur group names, phone numbers, recruiter names and company contact details; include only where public sharing is permitted.

5. Before you submit

- Replace every [enter] with a real finding and its E-ID or S-ID.
- Cite S1–S5 in your own words with full citations, and check each link opens.
- Keep “reported” wording on every national figure; do not present it as your own measurement.
- Label targets as targets; they are not findings.
- Keep each claim traceable: claim → E-ID or S-ID → file in the folder.